

per cent of American households do mothers take the lead in investing, and the figures are just as bleak in other parts of the world.

Sallie Krawcheck and Cathie Wood, both upper-class white women, are the only female investment powerhouses that we have in a sea of Warren Buffetts, Charlie Mungers, Benjamin Grahams and Peter Lynches. Representation is powerful, and until we have more women and minorities in the mainstream showing us what investors can look like, we will continue raising another generation of young women who believe that they aren't capable of being good investors.

A culture of shame around discussing money

Money is still seen as a taboo subject, one even parents are uncomfortable speaking about with their children. We grow up being told you don't ask people about their age, religion, politics and *especially* not money. For some odd reason I was stubbornly immune to these messages. I would always query my parents about our finances: how much did mum and dad make, how much did it cost for them to buy a home (back when home ownership was affordable), what was the cost of the car and why did they buy a cheaper old one in cash rather than a nicer car with a loan?

Whenever I visited the homes of friends who had money, I'd always ask what their parents did for a living so I could understand how they got to where they were. I have to admit I was a bit of a nosy kid, but to me the secrecy surrounding money never made sense. Knowledge is power. I would find those conversations both fascinating and helpful in growing my own money mindset — my relationship with how I viewed money — and understanding what steps other people took to get to where they were. Especially if I wanted to get there.

I truly believe keeping silent about money benefits no-one but those who are already powerful.

By keeping silent about money we only make it harder for women and minorities to get paid more, to negotiate better, to learn how to invest; by keeping money as a taboo topic, we only make it harder for more people to